



DATA VIZ PROCESS BOOK

NYC Restaurant Quality



1. Project Overview



Topic: NYC restaurant quality

①

RQ1: borough inspection patterns

②

RQ2: cuisine + neighborhood differences

③

RQ3: do reviews match inspections?



Main finding: inspections and reviews tell different stories



2. Data



NYC DOHMH inspections (2012-2024)



Borough boundaries + map data (NYC Open Data)



TripAdvisor reviews



Latest inspection record per restaurant



VADER sentiment (-1 to 1)



Fuzzy matching (name + addr)



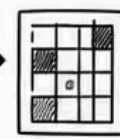
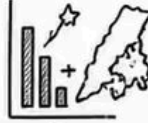
Limit: much more Grade A than B/C

3. Design Evolution

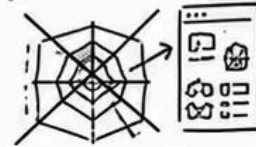
Rough sketch

Draft dashboard

Final website



Rejected idea



Less text, clearer pages ✓

4. Visualization Choices



Borough bar (avg score)



Grade A cluster (map)



Borough map (avg score)



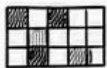
Word cloud (A vs B/C)



Grade stacked (A / B / C)



Sentiment dist (VADER)



Cuisine x borough heatmap



Sentiment vs inspection (score)

5. Interactivity Choices

FILTERS

Borough

All

Cuisine

All

Metric

Avg Score



Hover tooltips



Explain data



Page nav (sidebar)



Removed extra widgets → keep it simple!

6. Storytelling & Structure



Overview (big picture)



Official Inspections (borough patterns)



Cuisine & Neighborhood (differences)



Public Reviews (sentiment)



Conclusion (key takeaways)



7. Polish Checklist

- ☐ Titles
- ☐ Labels
- ☐ Legends
- ☐ Tooltip text
- ☐ Spacing
- ☐ Contrast
- ☐ README / deploy
- ☐ Clear takeaway

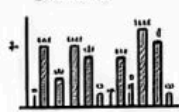


8. Feedback & Final Changes



- Explain VADER scale (-1 to 1)
- Simplify takeaways
- Use avg score for map
- Keep text shorter
- Note small B/C sample
- Clarify metric meaning

Before



After



9. Challenges & Limitations



Fuzzy matching not perfect



Small B/C sample



Reviews mostly positive



Weak sentiment link to inspection scores



Future: closure question + better NLP



Inspections show sanitation.
Reviews show customer experience.
Together they give a fuller picture.

